

Wedding Planning Checklist

12–18 Months Before

Vision + Budget

- ☐ Define your wedding vision: theme, size, vibe, and location (local or destination).
- ☐ Set your total budget and prioritize spending (venue, food, dress, photography).
- ☐ Create a shared Google Sheet or Notion workspace for planning.

Guest List + Date

- ☐ Draft your preliminary guest list.
- ☐ Choose potential wedding dates and check with key guests/family.

Venue + Planner

- ☐ Research and visit venues (ceremony and reception).
- ☐ Book your venue early – this often determines your date.
- ☐ Consider hiring a wedding planner or coordinator (full-service or day-of).

Vendors

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|--|-------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Photographer & Videographer | ☐ Caterer | ☐ Hair & Makeup Artist |
| ☐ Decor/Styling Team | ☐ DJ or Band | ☐ Florist |

9–12 Months Before

Bridal Party + Attire

- ☐ Choose your bridal party (maid of honor, best man, bridesmaids, groomsmen).
- ☐ Begin shopping for wedding dress/outfit – allow time for fittings and alterations.
- ☐ Research attire for bridesmaids, groomsmen, and parents.

Vendors (Book Key Ones)

- ☐ Book photographer, videographer, caterer, and entertainment.
- ☐ Hire florist, décor stylist, or event designer.
- ☐ Reserve officiant.

Accommodation

- ☐ Reserve hotel room blocks for guests (especially for destination weddings).
- ☐ Plan transportation if venues are far apart.

6–9 Months Before

Details + Design

- Order save-the-dates and send them out.
- Finalize menu options and schedule tastings.
- Choose color palette, flowers, and décor theme.

Fashion & Beauty

- Choose bridal shoes and accessories.
- Book hair and makeup artists for trials.
- Begin skincare/haircare prep routines.

Wedding Website

- Create a wedding website with RSVP, travel info, dress code, and registry details.

Entertainment & Extras

- Book any extras like a photo booth, fireworks, or live performers.

4–6 Months Before

Attire & Fittings

- Schedule your first dress fitting.
- Select groom and groomsmen outfits.
- Finalize bridesmaids' dresses and accessories.

Stationery

- Design and order invitations.
- Order ceremony programs, menus, and place cards.

Vows & Ceremony

- Begin writing your vows.
- Finalize your ceremony structure and readings.
- Confirm details with your officiant.

Registry

- Finalize your gift registry (or honeymoon fund).

2–4 Months Before

Final Details

- Send wedding invitations (8–10 weeks before the date).
- Finalize menu and drink selections.
- Confirm floral arrangements and décor setup.
- Create a wedding day timeline (from prep to last dance).